18.3 The ECS basics: Cluster, service, task, and task definition

When working with ECS, you need to create a cluster first. A cluster is a logical group for all the components we discuss next. It is fine to create multiple clusters to isolate workloads from each other. For example, we typically create different clusters for test and production environments. The cluster itself is free, and by default, you can create up to 10,000 clusters—which you probably do not need, by the way.

To run a container on ECS, you need to create a task definition. The task definition includes all the information required to run a container, as shown here. See figure 18.3 for more details:

- The container image URL
- Provisioned baseline and limit for CPU
- Provisioned baseline and limit for memory
- Environment variables
- Network configuration

Please note: a task definition might describe one or multiple containers.